

Book Cover Workbook

Based directly on the lesson transcript. Designed as a companion workbook.

Step 1 – Research Amazon

- Search Amazon for books in your niche.
- Screenshot 10–20 covers you like.
- Study fonts, colors, layouts, imagery, subtitle placement, and author placement.
- Look at Amazon Best Sellers for additional inspiration.
- Write down patterns you notice.

Research Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Step 2 – Plan Your Cover

- Decide what emotion your cover should communicate.
- Choose a color palette that fits your genre.
- Choose one strong focal image.
- Keep the design clean and balanced.

Color / Font Ideas

Step 3 – Canva Build

- Open Canva.
- Search for 'Book Cover'.
- Choose a template close to your niche.
- Customize the template.
- Replace title.

- Replace subtitle.
- Replace author name.
- Delete unnecessary graphics/text.
- Replace imagery if needed.
- Adjust fonts.
- Adjust spacing.
- Balance all elements.

Step 4 – Technical Requirements

- Ebook: Save as JPG (preferred) or TIFF.
- Use the Canva template dimensions demonstrated in the lesson.
- Paperback: Use 6 x 9 trim size for this course.
- Remember a paperback requires a FRONT, SPINE, and BACK cover.
- After your manuscript is complete, use the Amazon KDP Cover Calculator.
- The calculator requires: trim size, paper type, ink type, and final page count.
- Do NOT calculate the paperback cover until your manuscript is finished.

KDP Cover Calculator

Link to bookmark: <https://kdp.amazon.com/cover-calculator>

Step 5 – Final Review

- Can I read the title as a thumbnail?
- Does the cover fit the genre?
- Does it build trust?
- Does it look professionally published?
- Is the design balanced?
- Would I click on this book?

Homework

- Create your cover in Canva.
- Download it to your computer.
- Share it for feedback.

Key Takeaways

- People judge books by their covers.
- Simple beats cluttered.
- Typography matters.

- Color psychology matters.
- Use high-quality imagery.
- Research successful covers before designing your own.